Sora Hanzawa

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EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley — **Aug. 2026 – May 2028 (Expected)**
Bachelor of Arts in Political Economy — *CA, U.S.A.*
- Relevant coursework: Macroeconomics, The International Economy of the 20th Century

Santa Monica College — **Aug. 2024 – Jun. 2026**
Associate Degree in Economics — *CA, U.S.A.*
- GPA: 4.0/4.0 – Scholars Program & Highest Honor
- Relevant coursework: Statistics, Calculus, Business Intro, Macroeconomics, Microeconomics

INTERNSHIP & WORK EXPERIENCE

Digital Securities Co., Ltd. — **Jul. 2026 – Aug. 2026**
Business Development & Research Intern — *Tokyo, Japan*
- Generated business opportunities with 3 overseas firms: pitched to a VC from San Francisco at the WebX business event, advancing discussions to the CEO level with all three companies.
- Pioneered the firm's first student internship: proactively approached a company with no prior internship program and secured its first-ever intern position.

Biz Dev Dojo — **Jun. 2025 – Sep. 2025**
Business Podcast Intern — *Online*
- Co-hosted a weekly business podcast with a former investment banking (IBD) professional, curating and analyzing current news for the CEOs of client consulting firms.
- Produced weekly PowerPoint decks summarizing key industry and market news to structure each episode's discussion content.

Sparkle — **Aug. 2025 – Sep. 2025**
Business Accelerator Intern — *Online*
- Supported a business accelerator event for Sparkle, a Tohoku-based venture capital firm, by designing and executing a social media and networking outreach strategy.
- Attracted over 400 attendees to the event, exceeding turnout expectations through targeted SNS campaigns and direct networking efforts.

Textbook Revision Leader, Eitango 2100 — **Feb. 2024 – Mar. 2024**
Educational Tech Intern & Leader — *Tokyo, Japan*
- Spearheaded the revision of the English vocabulary textbook "Eitango 2100" as the leader of a 3-person team, collaborating with educational publisher Zoshindo and educational influencer Rao-sensei (over 900K followers).
- Engineered the recreation of 2,100 example sentences by integrating generative AI, feeding it actual high school entrance exam materials to ensure context-appropriate content; accelerated project delivery by approximately 25%, completing under 3 weeks.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE & KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

UCLA Debate — **Sep. 2024 – Dec. 2024**
External Member — *Los Angeles, U.S.*
- First external university member admitted to the club: secured membership through persistent negotiation during observation sessions and coffee chats, later serving as a judge for a high school debate tournament.
- Ranked 2nd of 8 members within 4 months: analyzed personal weaknesses and improved logical argumentation through speech analysis of top members, repeated practice, and continuous feedback.

SmiRing @smiring_us.california — **Aug. 2024 – Feb. 2025**
Social Media Marketing Leader | Nov. 2024 – Feb. 2025 — *Online*
- Managed a 4-person student marketing team to launch the organization's first official Instagram account from scratch, successfully driving follower growth from 0 to over 200 within the first month.
- Executed targeted digital outreach campaigns to connect with Japanese exchange students, while coordinating weekly chapter meetings to foster community engagement.

LA Cycle — **Nov. 2024 – Feb. 2025**
Volunteer — *LA, USA*
- Managed on-site logistics, including unloading, venue setup, and distribution, while building relationships with recurring participants and expanding outreach to individuals in need.
- Volunteered weekly to reduce food waste by collecting surplus food from supermarkets and distributing it to people in need.

LANGUAGES, SKILLS & INTERESTS

- **Languages:** Japanese (Native/N2), English (Native/C2), French (Intermediate/B1), Korean (Intermediate/Ba)
- **Skills:** Public Speaking, Communication & Presentation, Leadership & Collaboration, Microsoft Office & Google Workspace
- **Interests:** Finance & Business, Chess, Workout, Swimming, Running